

Chapter 174-6

When dreams came at midnight, she still thought of Zhao Xuning. The occasional phantom that appeared when passing by the university campus was still Zhao Xuning.

Day and night, she punished herself. Day and night, she couldn't let go, couldn't move on.

Such days left Shen Hui utterly exhausted.

She always wanted to find a sunny, peaceful day to end this exhausting life.

Yet she lacked the courage to stake everything on one throw.

After Shen Hui hung up the phone, she saw the lavishly dressed noblewoman walking toward her, her high heels striking the ground with resounding clicks.

Shen Hui met her gaze with neither servility nor arrogance.

"You're Shen Hui?" the other party asked.

Shen Hui nodded: "That's me."

"I'm Zhao Xuning's mother." The other party introduced herself: "Did you know she's on the hot search?"

"I just heard about it," Shen Hui replied.

Her tone was bland. She didn't put on a pleasant expression just because the other party was Zhao Xuning's mother—she remained cold.

Mother Zhao froze. She was already angry, and now her temper flared even more at Shen Hui's tone.

"You made her kneel her way up three thousand steps? Are you crazy?" Mother Zhao said angrily. "From childhood to adulthood, aside from kneeling during ancestral worship on holidays, when has she ever knelt? She dates you and loses half her life in the process. Where's my spirited daughter from before? Isn't that enough yet? Do you want to torment her to death?!"

Hearing this, Shen Hui's eyes swept over her indifferently, her voice slowing: "She chose to do it herself."

"Would she have done this if not for you?" Mother Zhao said coldly. "Ever since she met you, she's gone crazy. You've nearly driven her mad."

Shen Hui curved her lips into a light smile, not knowing who had caused her own transformation over these years.

The formerly lofty Second Miss of the Shen family, who looked down on everyone—she too had become meek and submissive for Zhao Xuning.

Shen Hui's smile widened on her face as she said indifferently: "Whatever."

After all, they had gone crazy together.

Bound together for this lifetime—let them be crazy then.

Mother Zhao's eyes immediately widened. Furious, she raised her hand to slap her, but her arm was blocked. A clear, youthful voice rang out: "Are you crazy?"

A tall figure immediately blocked Shen Hui, shielding her completely.

"A-Yan," Shen Hui called out to him softly.

But Shen Siyan, who had run over sweating profusely, frowned and stared coldly at the person opposite. "No one has ever hit my sister in her entire life. If you actually lay a hand on her, I don't care who you are—you can say goodbye to that arm."

When Liang Shi arrived, this was exactly what she heard.

Then she heard Shen Siyan continue: "I don't care how your Zhao Xuning goes crazy. The girls of our Shen family are all raised as treasures in the palm of our hands. Try touching a single hair on her."

Mother Zhao froze, then laughed angrily: "What big talk."

"If you don't believe it, feel free to try." Shen Siyan stared at her coldly. "Hasn't the Zhao family's business been doing poorly lately? Didn't your cooperation with Hejing fall through?"

Mother Zhao was stunned: "How do you know?"

Shen Siyan curved his lips into a cold smile: "Because I'm the one who did it, of course."

Hearing this, Shen Hui pinched his arm. "A-Yan, stop talking."

Shen Siyan patted her hand reassuringly. "Second Sister, it's fine. Don't be scared."

Shen Hui's brows furrowed slightly.

Shen Siyan looked at Mother Zhao and continued: "This is just a small punishment. If it were my eldest sister or my father standing here today, the Zhao family could really be waiting for bankruptcy. The way you treated my second sister back then—the Zhao family will pay the corresponding price."

Mother Zhao frowned: "Who are you people?"

Seeing that they were about to have a full-blown argument, Liang Shi immediately stepped forward and called out: "Shen Hui."

She directly inserted herself between Mother Zhao and Shen Siyan.

Shen Siyan frowned slightly but said nothing.

Liang Shi looked at Mother Zhao and said gently: "Auntie, I'm Zhao Xuning's friend. This is her choice. You... let's just wait for her quietly."

The implication was—stop causing trouble. Zhao Xuning wouldn't want to see this.

Someone who had to kneel her way up three thousand steps to win her back—don't let her mother ruin it with a few careless words.

It was tragic enough to make even ghosts cry.

Liang Shi could only help minimize the damage for Zhao Xuning.

Mother Zhao was unwilling, but she also understood her daughter's situation. So she sent people up to find Zhao Xuning, while Shen Hui and Shen Siyan took the cable car up the mountain.

Liang Shi took the steps.

Walking was still faster than kneeling and bowing with each step. However, Zhao Xuning was also moving quite fast and had already completed half.

Liang Shi had a hard time catching up to her.

When she finally caught up, Zhao Xuning's forehead was already bruised from the kowtowing, her lips cracked, her complexion deathly pale. Two bodyguards in black were beside her trying to persuade her to go down, but Zhao Xuning told them to get lost. She persisted unwaveringly, kneeling and bowing with standard movements as she climbed.

Liang Shi couldn't say anything either. She just handed her a bottle of water when she stood up.

Zhao Xuning closed her eyes briefly, sweat dripping from her forehead, and continued upward.